

## The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

### Subject Description Form

*Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.*

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| <b>Subject Code</b>                                          | CHC341                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Subject Title</b>                                         | Arts and Heritages of Buddhism in China and Asia<br>中國和亞洲的佛教藝術與遺跡                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Credit Value</b>                                          | 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Level</b>                                                 | 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Pre-requisite/<br/>Co-requisite/<br/>Exclusion</b>        | Nil                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Objectives</b>                                            | This subject introduces the development of Buddhist art and heritages in China and wider Asia by situating them within relevant art historical, societal and religious contexts. While generally following a chronological order, this course adopts a “dual threads of structuring.” The first half of the course is organized under the theme of “interactions within Asia”, with a focus on the issues of iconography, style, patronage and politics. The second half employs a more religious approach to structure materials according to the key beliefs and schools of Buddhism to which they are affiliated, putting an emphasis on Buddhist doctrines, rituals and practices, as well as functions of art and architecture in various religious contexts. |
| <b>Intended Learning Outcomes</b><br>(Note 1)                | Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to:<br>a) conduct critical analysis and present well-organized materials;<br>b) obtain a visual literacy of Buddhist images and analyse them with basic art historical methods and approaches;<br>c) understand the basic doctrines of Buddhism and a general clue on the development history of Buddhist art and heritages in China as well as their relationships with various other countries;<br>d) reflect on the intricate relationships among images, texts and rituals in the domain of Buddhism.                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Subject Synopsis/<br/>Indicative Syllabus</b><br>(Note 2) | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Preface: Doctrines and Development: Introduction to Buddhism and Buddhist Art</li> <li>2. Aniconism and Early Buddhist Art of Kushan India and Central Asia (3<sup>rd</sup> c. BCE- 6<sup>th</sup> c. CE)</li> <li>3. Early Chinese Buddhist Images in the Tomb Context (2<sup>nd</sup> c. BCE to 3<sup>rd</sup> c. CE))</li> <li>4. Iconography and Style: Buddhist Sculptures of East Asia (4<sup>th</sup> c. CE to 8<sup>th</sup> c. CE)</li> <li>5. Patronage and Politics: Cave-shrines and Monasteries of East Asia (5<sup>th</sup> c. to 13<sup>th</sup> c. CE)</li> <li>6. Narrative and Representation: Buddhist Paintings of East Asia (10<sup>th</sup> c. to 16<sup>th</sup> c. CE)</li> </ol>                |

|                                                                                        | 7. Maitreya Belief in East Asian Art<br>8. Pure Land Art in East Asia<br>9. The Art of Hell in East Asia<br>10. Chan/Seon/Zen Art in East Asia<br>11. Tantric Art in Tibet, Nepal and India<br>12. Epilogue: Collecting, Displaying and Interpreting Buddhist Art in Modern Western World                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                   |             |                                                                                |   |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |
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| <b>Teaching/Learning Methodology</b><br><br>(Note 3)                                   | Lectures will provide the theoretical methods as well as core art historical and Buddhist knowledges related to the scope of this course. In-class discission sessions will be dedicated to in-depth analysis and critical assessment of the key ideas, arguments and evidence of the chosen reading material. It is a process for the students to apply the methods/knowledges they learned in the lectures on concrete cases as well as an opportunity for them to experience and imitate the trajectory of doing academic research by bisecting and digesting the chosen material. The scholarship debating game and reading response paper are variant forms of tasks to train the students’ skills in applying knowledge to solve academic problems and conducting critical reasoning. A mid-term quiz will test students’ grasp of their knowledge of the content of the subject. A term paper will solidify students’ knowledge of the subject while facilitate their independence in thinking and writing.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                   |             |                                                                                |   |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| <b>Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes</b><br><br>(Note 4) | <table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="6">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th><th></th><th></th></tr><tr><td>1. In-class Assessment</td><td>10%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2. Oral Presentation</td><td>20%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3. Reading Response Paper</td><td>5%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4. Scholarship Debate Game</td><td>5%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4. Mid Term Quiz</td><td>20%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4. Final Paper</td><td>40%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>100 %</td><td colspan="6"></td></tr></table> <p>Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:</p> <p>All assessment methods involve the key task of analyzing visual works and physical sites in conjunction with relevant historical and ritual contexts and thereby present an organized response either orally or in writing, which applies for all intended learning outcomes specified in the earlier page.</p> | Specific assessment methods/tasks | % weighting | Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate) |   |  |  |  |  | a | b | c | d |  |  | 1. In-class Assessment | 10% | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |  |  | 2. Oral Presentation | 20% | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |  |  | 3. Reading Response Paper | 5% | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |  |  | 4. Scholarship Debate Game | 5% | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |  |  | 4. Mid Term Quiz | 20% | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |  |  | 4. Final Paper | 40% | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |  |  | Total | 100 % |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| Specific assessment methods/tasks                                                      | % weighting                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                   |             | Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate) |   |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | a                                 | b           | c                                                                              | d |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 1. In-class Assessment                                                                 | 10%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ✓                                 | ✓           | ✓                                                                              | ✓ |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 2. Oral Presentation                                                                   | 20%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ✓                                 | ✓           | ✓                                                                              | ✓ |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 3. Reading Response Paper                                                              | 5%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ✓                                 | ✓           | ✓                                                                              | ✓ |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 4. Scholarship Debate Game                                                             | 5%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ✓                                 | ✓           | ✓                                                                              | ✓ |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 4. Mid Term Quiz                                                                       | 20%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ✓                                 | ✓           | ✓                                                                              | ✓ |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 4. Final Paper                                                                         | 40%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ✓                                 | ✓           | ✓                                                                              | ✓ |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| Total                                                                                  | 100 %                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                   |             |                                                                                |   |  |  |  |  |   |   |   |   |  |  |                        |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                      |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                           |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                            |    |   |   |   |   |  |  |                  |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |                |     |   |   |   |   |  |  |       |       |  |  |  |  |  |  |

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| <b>Student Study Effort Expected</b> | Class contact:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |         |
|                                      | ▪ Lectures                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 26Hrs.  |
|                                      | ▪ In-class Discussion Sessions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 10Hrs.  |
|                                      | ▪ Field Trip                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 3Hrs    |
|                                      | Other student study effort:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |         |
|                                      | ▪ Reading                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 43Hrs.  |
|                                      | ▪ Writing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 30Hrs.  |
|                                      | ▪ Out-of-class Discussions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 8Hrs    |
|                                      | Total student study effort                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 120Hrs. |
| <b>Reading List and References</b>   | <p>Abe, Stanley K. <i>Ordinary Images</i>. Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2002.</p> <p>Berger, Patricia. <i>Empire of Emptiness: Buddhist Art and Political Authority in Qing China</i>. Honolulu: University of Hawaii Press, 2002.</p> <p>Chou, Wen-shing. <i>Mount Wutai: Visions of A Sacred Mountain</i>. Princeton: Princeton University Press, 2018.</p> <p>Huntington, Eric. <i>Creating the Universe: Depictions of the Cosmos in Himalayan Buddhism</i>. Seattle: University Washington Press, 2019.</p> <p>Gethin, Rupert. <i>The Foundations of Buddhism</i>. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1998.</p> <p>Lee, Sonya. <i>Surviving Nirvana: Death of Buddha in Chinese Visual Culture</i>. Hong Kong: University of Hong Kong Press, 2010.</p> <p>Leidy, P Denise. <i>The Art of Buddhism</i>. Boston and London: Shambhala, 2008.</p> <p>Levine, Gregory. <i>Daitokuji: The Visual Cultures of a Zen Monastery</i>. Seattle: University Washington Press, 2005.</p> <p>Li, Yuhang. <i>Becoming Guanyin: Artistic Devotion of Buddhist Women in Late Imperial China</i>. New York: Columbia University Press, 2020.</p> <p>Lin, Wei-cheng. <i>Building A Sacred Mountain: The Buddhist Architecture of China's Mount Wutai</i>. Seattle: University Washington Press, 2013.</p> <p>McNair, Amy. <i>Donors of Longmen: Faith, Politics, and Patronage in Medieval Chinese Buddhist Sculpture</i>. Honolulu: University of Hawaii Press, 2007.</p> <p>O'Neal Halle. <i>Word Embodied: The Jeweled Pagoda Mandalas in Japanese Buddhist Art</i>. Cambridge: Harvard University Asia Center, 2018.</p> <p>Said, Edward. <i>Orientalism</i>. New York: Vintage Books, 1979.</p> |         |

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|  | <p>Shen, Hsueh-man. <i>Authentic Replicas: Buddhist Art in Medieval China</i>. Honolulu: University of Hawaii Press, 2019.</p> <p>Steinhardt, Nancy. <i>Chinese Architecture: A History</i>. Princeton: Princeton University Press, 2019.</p> <p>Wang, Y. Eugene. <i>Shaping the Lotus Sutra: Buddhist Visual Culture in Medieval China</i>. Seattle: University Washington Press, 2005.</p> <p>Wang, C. Michelle. <i>Mandalas in the Making: The Visual Culture of Esoteric Buddhism at Dunhuang</i>. Leiden: Brill, 2018.</p> <p>Wong, C. Dorothy. <i>Chinese Steles: Pre-Buddhist and Buddhist Use of a Symbolic Form</i>. Honolulu: University of Hawaii Press, 2004.</p> <p>Chang, Qing 常青. <i>Chang'an yu Luoyang: Wu zhi jiu shiji liangjing fojiao yushu yanjiu</i> 長安與洛陽: 五至九世紀兩京佛教藝術研究. Beijing: Wenwu chubanshe, 2020.</p> <p>He, Zhiguo 何志國. <i>Hanjin foxiang zonghe yanjiu</i> 漢晉佛像綜合研究. Shanghai: Shanghai renmin chubanshe, 2017.</p> <p>Wu, Hung 巫鴻. <i>Kongjian de Dunhuang: zou jin Mogao ku</i> 空間的敦煌: 走近莫高窟. Shanghai: Sanlian shudian, 2022.</p> |
|  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

(Form AR 140) 8.2020